

GECKOS

Widely distributed in the tropics and subtropics, the superfamily Gekkonidae number over 1,000 species in 100 genera. They are noted for being very vocal and for their ability to climb smooth surfaces. Many lay hard-shelled eggs, while others lay soft-shelled eggs. Some species are viviparous.



COMMON LEOPARD GECKO
Eublepharis macularius

Originally from southern C. Asia, this gecko is a popular pet, which has been bred for different markings and colours.

21 cm
8½ in



WESTERN BANDED GECKO

Coleonyx variegatus

This terrestrial gecko hunts invertebrates in the deserts of the W. USA. Unlike many geckos, it has moveable eyelids.

12 cm
4¾ in



MOORISH GECKO

Tarentola mauritanica

Common around the Mediterranean, this agile gecko preys on insects. It lives on rock faces but often enters houses.

15 cm
6 in



AFRICAN FAT-TAILED GECKO

Hemiteconyx caudicinctus

Common in the W. Sahara, this species has a tail that stores fat. It lacks the adhesive foot pads of many other geckos.

25 cm
10 in

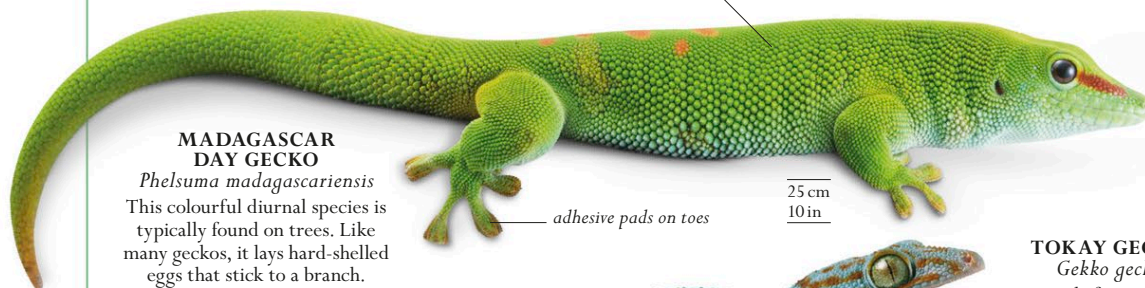


WONDER GECKO

Teratoscincus scincus

To defend itself, this C. Asian species waves its tail slowly, causing a row of large scales on the tail to rub together, making a hissing sound.

20 cm
8 in



MADAGASCAR DAY GECKO

Phelsuma madagascariensis

This colourful diurnal species is typically found on trees. Like many geckos, it lays hard-shelled eggs that stick to a branch.

40 cm
16 in

bright coloration

adhesive pads on toes

25 cm
10 in



TOKAY GECKO

Gekko gecko

Named after its harsh "to-kay" call, this large gecko from S.E. Asia often lives in houses.

15 cm
6 in



KUHL'S FLYING GECKO

Ptychozoon kuhli

This gecko's webbed toes and skin flaps help break its fall as it parachutes from trees in the rainforests of S.E. Asia.

20 cm
8 in



RING-TAILED GECKO

Cyrtodactylus louisiadensis

Found in New Guinea, this large, nocturnal gecko feeds aggressively on invertebrates and small frogs found on the ground.

34 cm
13½ in



BROOK'S HOUSE GECKO

Hemidactylus brookii

This gecko lives in close proximity to humans. Native to N. India, it now also occurs in Hong Kong, Shanghai, and the Philippines.



MEDITERRANEAN GECKO

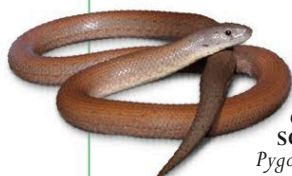
Hemidactylus turcicus

Often betrayed by its mewling cry, this small European gecko is common in houses, where it hunts insects attracted to lights.

10 cm
4 in

FLAP-FOOTED LIZARDS

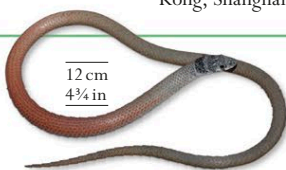
All lizards of this group have an elongated body, no front limbs, and much-reduced hind limbs. Restricted to Australasia, the 36 species in the family Pygopodidae hunt insects by burrowing or on the surface. They are related to geckos and lay soft-shelled eggs.



COMMON SCALY FOOT
Pygopus lepidopodus

Snake-like in appearance, this lizard is widespread in Australia. It is a diurnal predator of insects and tunnel-inhabiting spiders.

21 cm
8½ in



FRASER'S DELMA

Delma fraseri

This insectivorous, Australian lizard inhabits spinifex grassland. It is well adapted to moving through the stiff blades of grass.

12 cm
4¾ in



BURTON'S SNAKE-LIZARD

Lialis burtonis

Native to Australia, this lizard has an elongated, wedge-shaped snout that it uses to grasp skinks, which it consumes whole.

60 cm
23½ in

ANOLES

Most anoles come from around the Caribbean. A diverse group, the Dactyloidae are typically small, arboreal, and insectivorous. Although often green or brown, they change skin colour according to mood and environment. Both sexes aggressively defend their territories.

KNIGHT ANOLE

Anolis equestris

The largest anole, this species is restricted to Cuba. Adhesive pads on its toes enable it to scale smooth walls.

50 cm
20 in

GREEN ANOLE

Anolis carolinensis

Males show their dominance by bobbing their heads and flaring their brightly coloured throat fan.

20 cm
8 in

